Alex Chen

Senior Backend Engineer

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Summary

Backend engineer with seven years of experience building high-throughput payment and logistics APIs in Python and Go. I care about clear service boundaries, observability and boring, reliable deploys.

Experience

Senior Backend Engineer, Ledgerly · Seattle, WA — Mar 2022 – Present

- Led the redesign of the payments ledger service in Python (FastAPI) and PostgreSQL, cutting p99 latency from 480 ms to 120 ms.
- Introduced Kafka-based event sourcing for 40M monthly transactions.
- Mentored four engineers and ran the backend interview loop.

Backend Engineer, Parcelpoint · Remote — Jul 2019 – Feb 2022

- Built route-optimization APIs in Go and gRPC serving 3,000 requests per second at peak.
- Moved services from EC2 to Kubernetes on AWS (EKS), managed with Terraform.
- Added Redis caching that reduced primary database load by 35%.

Software Engineer Intern, Parcelpoint · Seattle, WA — May 2018 – Aug 2018

- Wrote Django admin tooling used daily by warehouse operations staff.

Education

B.S., Computer Science, University of Washington, 2019

Skills

Languages: Python, Go, SQL

Frameworks: FastAPI, Django, gRPC

Data & infrastructure: PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS, Terraform